Step 4: In this step, the six carbon, fructose-1,6-bisphosphate splits to form two three-carbon sugars namely dihydroxyacetone phosphate (DHAP) and glyceraldehyde-3-phosphate. They are isomers of each other. This step is catalysed by the enzyme aldolase.

Step 5: The interconversion of DHAP and glyceraldehyde-3-phosphate is catalysed by triose phosphate isomerase enzyme. The two molecules exist in equilibrium, but the equilibrium shifted towards the formation of glyceraldehyde-3-phosphate as it is consumed in subsequent steps of glycolysis. Eventually as the glycolysis continues, all of the DHAP is converted into glyceraldehyde-3-phosphate(Figure 3.3).

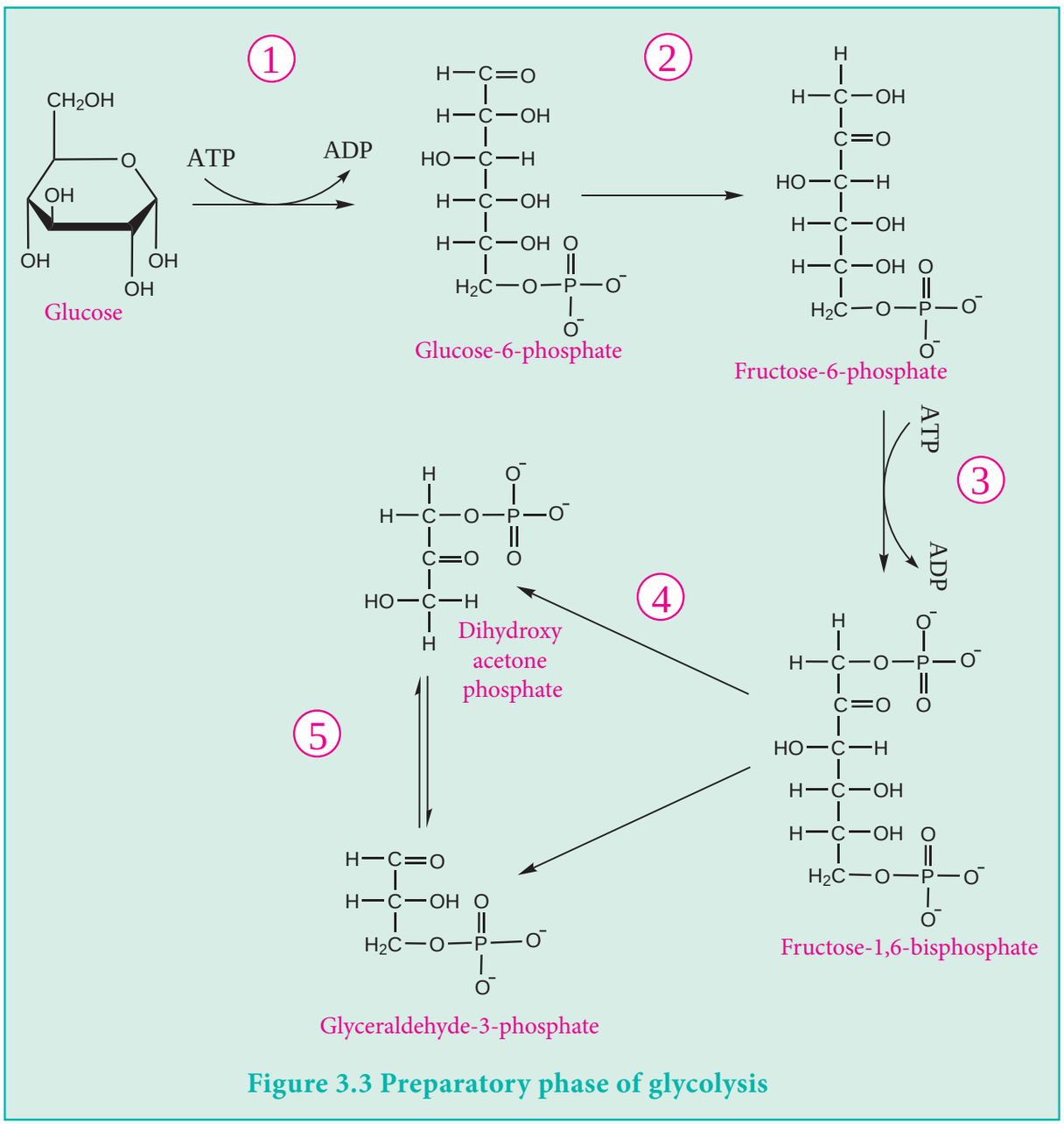


Figure 3.3 Preparatory phase of glycolysis

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